CLASS 10 — ENGLISH · HARD LEVEL CHAPTER TEST SET 3

Chapter 21: **A Tiger in the Zoo (First Flight Poem)** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 1 Hour 30 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 40**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–10 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 11–14 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 15–18 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 19–20 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 17 to 20.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Hard level: application and higher-order questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 10 × 1 = 10

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. The poem might be compared to 'The Trees' because both: 1

(a) have child characters **(b)** are comic
(c) are about cities **(d)** present nature as confined and longing

2. The poem's resolution is: 1

(a) a rescue **(b)** a death
(c) emotional rather than narrative **(d)** a joke

3. Enjambment in the poem helps to: 1

(a) break the poem **(b)** create rhyme only
(c) stop speech **(d)** mimic the tiger's continuous pacing

4. Which phrase would a critic call 'loaded language'? 1

(a) the bars **(b)** the tiger
(c) the cage **(d)** terrorising the village

5. The tiger can be read as a symbol of: 1

(a) restrained natural power **(b)** domestic life
(c) wealth **(d)** speed

6. The poem's irony is that the tiger, a symbol of power, is: 1

(a) powerless in confinement **(b)** powerful in zoos
(c) a pet **(d)** a guard

7. The tiger's behaviour in the poem is best described as: 1

(a) playful **(b)** ill
(c) instinctive but frustrated **(d)** learned and calm

8. A reader might find the poem more effective if read: 1

(a) fast **(b)** slowly with pauses
(c) without stops **(d)** loudly

9. The stars and the tiger's eyes share the adjective 'brilliant' to: 1

(a) link the captive with the free universe **(b)** show a car
(c) describe the keeper's torch **(d)** show a flashlight

10. Which sentence uses inversion for emphasis? 1

(a) The tiger forgets. **(b)** Never does the tiger forget the jungle.
(c) Forget the jungle he never. **(d)** The tiger never forgets the jungle.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) — 4 × 2 = 8

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

11. How could the poem relate to human captivity? 2

12. Why might the poet have mentioned 'cars' rather than guards? 2

13. Evaluate the use of a third-person observer. 2

14. Why is the tiger a powerful symbol for the poet's message? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) — 4 × 3 = 12

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

15. Evaluate how the poem might shape the reader's view of zoos. 3

16. Rewrite as a short paragraph: 'He should be in the jungle but he is in a cage.' 3

17. What is the importance of the title? 3

OR

What does the poem suggest about the relationship between power and freedom? 3

18. Convert into the passive: 'Zoo keepers confine tigers in cells.' 3

OR

Evaluate the poem as an environmental text. 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) — 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

19. Compare 'A Tiger in the Zoo' and 'The Trees' as poems on nature and freedom. 5

OR

Describe how sound, rhythm and imagery combine to create an effect of confinement. 5

20. Write a speech opposing the caging of wild animals, using at least three ideas from the poem. 5

OR

Write a letter to the editor about a recent animal cruelty case, referring to the poem. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER — Total: 40 Marks

MASTERMIND